

DJ Scruggs

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Entrepreneurial full-stack generalist with robust technical expertise and deep experience in product ownership, ranging from early-stage startups to complex technical turnarounds. Proven capability in building scalable products across frontend, backend, infrastructure, and product decisions. Comfortable wearing many hats and shipping fast.

SKILL SUMMARY

- **Technical Leadership:** Led all technical decisions from architecture to deployment across multiple startups; rescued stalled projects as CTO and Technical Lead
- **Product Strategy:** Owned full product lifecycle from MVP through scale; advised bipartisan coalition of Attorneys General on child online safety and AI policy
- **Startup Advisor:** Early-stage advisor and hands-on builder for B2B SaaS, AI, and blockchain products; raised \$7M in equity capital
- **AI & Emerging Tech:** Deep focus on decentralized identity (DID), AI-generated deepfake detection, MCP servers, and blockchain infrastructure
- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, Ruby, PHP
- **Frameworks:** React Router, Next.js, React Native, Express, Flask, FastAPI, Ruby on Rails
- **Infra:** AWS, Docker, Fly.io, Vercel
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB
- **Tools:** Git, HubSpot, Zapier, Notion, GSuite

WORK HISTORY

Technical Advisor, Partnership for Youth Online Safety

Attorney Generals Alliance — December 2025 - present

- Advise a bipartisan coalition of state Attorneys General and industry leaders on child online safety
- Focus on decentralized identity (DID) for age verification and flagging AI-generated deepfakes

Senior Software Engineer (Product)

Freelance — October 2023 - present

- Built [Cardless ID](#) — nonprofit age verification platform using React Router V7, Firebase, and the Algorand blockchain for decentralized identity; mobile app in development on Expo
- Created [did-resolver-agent](#) — chain-agnostic MCP server enabling humans to issue cryptographically signed Verifiable Credentials to AI agents, scoping permissions without a central authority

- Developed [Blockchain Rangers](#) — full-stack blockchain scam detection with multi-factor risk scoring, real-time smart contract analysis, and DeepSeek LLM-generated risk assessments
- Launched [TRYBE](#) — Full-stack PWA in React/Remix with Prisma/Supabase and Fly.io deployment, built from Figma wireframes
- Migrated [Penelope Trunk](#) from WP Engine to DigitalOcean VPS; replaced \$25,000/yr Hubspot with custom Mailster setup at under \$1,500/yr; scaled email delivery to 200,000 messages/day via Amazon SES
- Rebuilt [Automated Penetration Testing Reporting System](#) with a React/Vite/Tailwind; now serves 2,000+ security professionals

Managing Partner & Technology Lead

BlueSpruce Holdings — June 2017 - October 2023

- Built and maintained a full-stack investor communication platform for a 330-unit multifamily real estate portfolio
- Architected the complete technology stack for investor reporting, deal management, and equity capital workflows
- Raised \$5 million in equity capital; delivered 7% annual cash flow

Chief Technology Officer

Content BLVD — March 2015 - June 2017

- Rescued a stalled influencer marketplace after two prior CTOs failed
- Salvaged the existing Node/PostgreSQL API and built an entirely new Mithril/CoffeeScript front end
- Launched within five months, reaching 10,000+ users

Technical Lead

Staunch Robots — August 2014 - March 2015

- Rescued a stalled client project by rebuilding the agile process and managing remote developers across South America and Europe
- Translated complex requirements across language and timezone barriers to deliver a working Ruby on Rails product

Chief Technology Officer

Avenir International — January 2014 - August 2014

- Led conversion from on-premises software to a multi-tenant SaaS architecture compliant with HIPAA and related medical regulations
- Stack included Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, Cisco IP Phones, and Twilio

Chief Technology Officer

StatsMix — October 2010 - January 2013

- Led all technical development of a TechStars-backed SaaS analytics platform from MVP through scale

- Integrated with 30+ third-party APIs including Google Analytics, Stripe, and Mailchimp
- Owned every technical decision from architecture to deployment; stack included Ruby on Rails, MySQL, jQuery, and Highcharts

Senior Software Engineer

SurveyGizmo — January 2008 - August 2010

- Joined as employee #5; helped scale a single-server PHP app to a Zend Framework deployment across two continents serving 80 countries
- Built Salesforce and ExactTarget integrations, supported the API, and built a new payment system for enterprise billing

Chief Privacy Officer

MessageMedia — December 1998 - December 2001

- Devised and enforced spam-prevention policies for one of the first email marketing companies
- Led thought leadership initiative in permission marketing, winning enterprise accounts including Cisco Systems and Dell

CEO & Co-founder

Distributed Bits — March 1996 - December 1998

- Created the industry's first email customer service platform; clients included Consumer Reports and the Chicago Board Options Exchange
- Acquired by MessageMedia; delivered 700% return to investors in two years

EDUCATION

BS in Music Education, Northwestern University